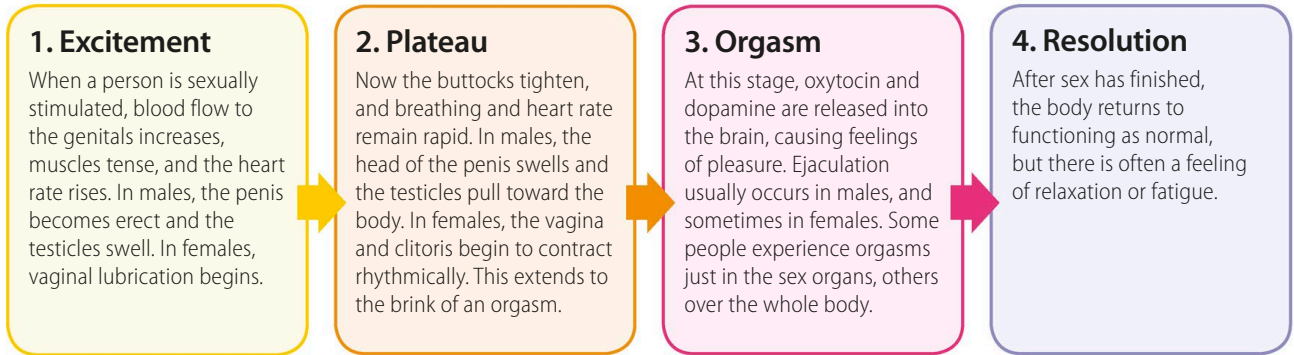


Sexual arousal response cycle

The sexual arousal response cycle has four stages.



Male and female orgasms

Men and women experience orgasms in similar ways, although there are key differences in the length, ejaculation, and recovery period.

The male orgasm

- Hand and feet muscles begin to spasm.
- Rhythmic contractions at the base of the penis, 4–6 times per orgasm, result in the ejaculation of semen from the penis.
- While most males experience orgasm as a result of sex, it's important to remember that some partners require additional stimulation.
- About half of the erection is lost immediately, and it goes down altogether soon after.
- After males experience an orgasm, it is usually not possible for them to get an erection again for a while.

The female orgasm

- Muscle contractions occur in the vagina, pelvic floor, anus, and uterus, typically 6–10 times per orgasm.
- It may take a prolonged period of sexual stimulation before females experience an orgasm during sex.
- Although some females orgasm as a result of vaginal sex, for many others it requires a variety of forms of stimulation of the genitals in addition to, or instead of, vaginal sex.
- Females can have a succession of orgasms.

Male and female ejaculation

Ejaculation is a reflex action that accompanies an orgasm. It's the release of fluid from the genitals.

Male ejaculation

This is the release of semen from the penis during orgasm. Semen contains the sex cell, sperm, which is produced and stored in the testicles. The tubes that store and transport semen contract to squeeze the fluid toward the base of the penis. Then, muscles at the base of the penis contract and push the semen out of the penis. In some males, the semen spurts out; in others, it dribbles out. Both are normal.

Female ejaculation

This is the involuntary release of fluid during or before orgasm. Some researchers think the fluid includes some urine, but it's important not to worry about this—it is normal and natural. Whether a woman ejaculates or not, it doesn't affect the intensity of an orgasm. The amount of fluid involved also varies from person to person.